

Organic Celeriac Information Pack

Introduction

Our organic celeriac this week comes from Laines Organic in West Sussex. Founded 45 years ago by Toos Jeuken, the farm sits on Horsham Green sand, a mineral rich 'super-soil' that is perfect for growing veg. Celeriac itself is a cultivar variant of the same plant that gives us celery. It is in the carrot and parsley family (called Apiaceae) that is characterised by a peppery taste.

Farm Information

Being organic, the growers must rely on the natural fertility of the soil to produce food. Soil organic carbon (SOC) levels are maintained using compost and manure, alongside minimal tillage to protect soil structure. Regenerating SOC levels using these techniques increases the water holding capacity of the soil, meaning they don't have to irrigate. Not only does no irrigation reduce the input and infrastructure costs on the farm, it also forces the plants to work a little harder, and root a little deeper, to find water which produces more tasty and nutritional fruit and vegetables (as you will hopefully see)

In place of synthetic chemical pesticides, the growers at Laines rely on natural predators. Leaving pockets of the farm untouched creates habitat that are connected by corridors such as 'beetle banks', predators can move around between crops in search of 'pests' effectively controlling their populations as part of the natural trophic process.

Nutritionally, celeriac stands out for its vitamin and mineral content: it is packed full of vitamin K, contributing to normal blood clotting and bone health, and provides vitamin C for immune function. It also contains potassium, phosphorus, calcium and magnesium, which support muscle function, bone strength and overall metabolic health.